

13

Grand Prix Attack

White's f-pawn attack, the Bb5 check, and Black's central counterstrike.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will see the attack before it is dangerous and respond with center play, square control, and accurate king placement.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 073 | PAGE 4

Decode: Grand Prix setup with ...g6*Against the Grand Prix, control the launch squares before chasing the attacking pieces.*

LESSON 074 | PAGE 8

Play: Grand Prix setup with ...g6*Against the Grand Prix, control the launch squares before chasing the attacking pieces.*

LESSON 075 | PAGE 12

Decode: The Bb5+ exchange decision*Trade attackers when the resulting structure remains playable and active.*

LESSON 076 | PAGE 16

Play: The Bb5+ exchange decision*Trade attackers when the resulting structure remains playable and active.*

LESSON 077 | PAGE 20

Decode: Central ...d5 against the attack*The center is the shortest route to an attacker whose pieces face the wing.*

LESSON 078 | PAGE 24

Play: Central ...d5 against the attack*The center is the shortest route to an attacker whose pieces face the wing.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will see the attack before it is dangerous and respond with center play, square control, and accurate king placement.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Grand Prix setup with ...g6



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

White develops an immediate kingside attack with f4 and often Qe1-h4, while Black seeks central and queenside counterplay.

DECISION RULE

Which square stops White's attack most efficiently: e5, d4, or the h4 route?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Control d4 and e5, exchange the active bishop when useful, and prepare ...e6 or ...Nd4.

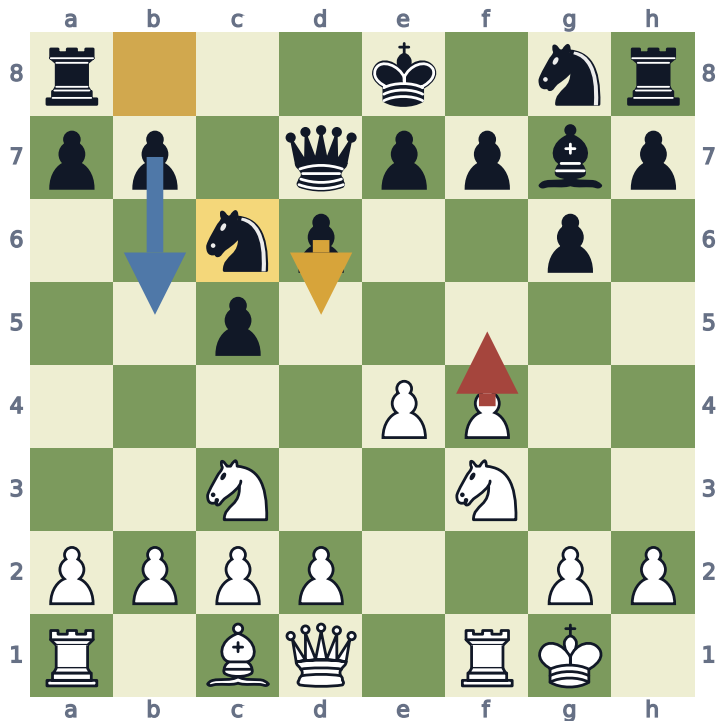
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses f5, Qe1-h4, and e5 to open the king before Black organizes the center.

MEMORY RULE | Against the Grand Prix, control the launch squares before chasing the attacking pieces.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White develops an immediate kingside attack with f4 and often Qe1-h4, while Black seeks central and queenside counterplay.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Control d4 and e5, exchange the active bishop when useful, and prepare ...e6 or ...Nd4.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White uses f5, Qe1-h4, and e5 to open the king before Black organizes the center.

FAILURE MODE

Castling automatically into a fully prepared attack without checking alternative king plans.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which square stops White's attack most efficiently: e5, d4, or the h4 route? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

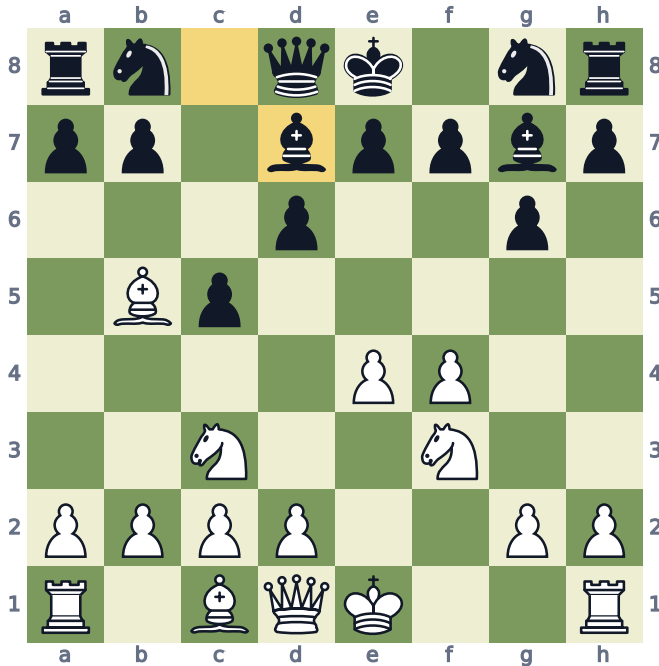
RULE | Against the Grand Prix, control the launch squares before chasing the attacking pieces.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 d6 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bb5+ Bd7 6. Bxd7+ Qxd7 7. O-O Nc6



- f4: White claims kingside space and announces e5 or f5 attacking ideas.
- g6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Nf3: White reroutes a knight to f3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bg7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bb5+: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bd7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

White develops an immediate kingside attack with f4 and often Qe1-h4, while Black seeks central and queenside counterplay.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which square stops White's attack most efficiently: e5, d4, or the h4 route? White's resistance is: White uses f5, Qe1-h4, and e5 to open the king before Black organizes the center. The line fails as a template when: Castling automatically into a fully prepared attack without checking alternative king plans.

STORE THIS | Against the Grand Prix, control the launch squares before chasing the attacking pieces.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

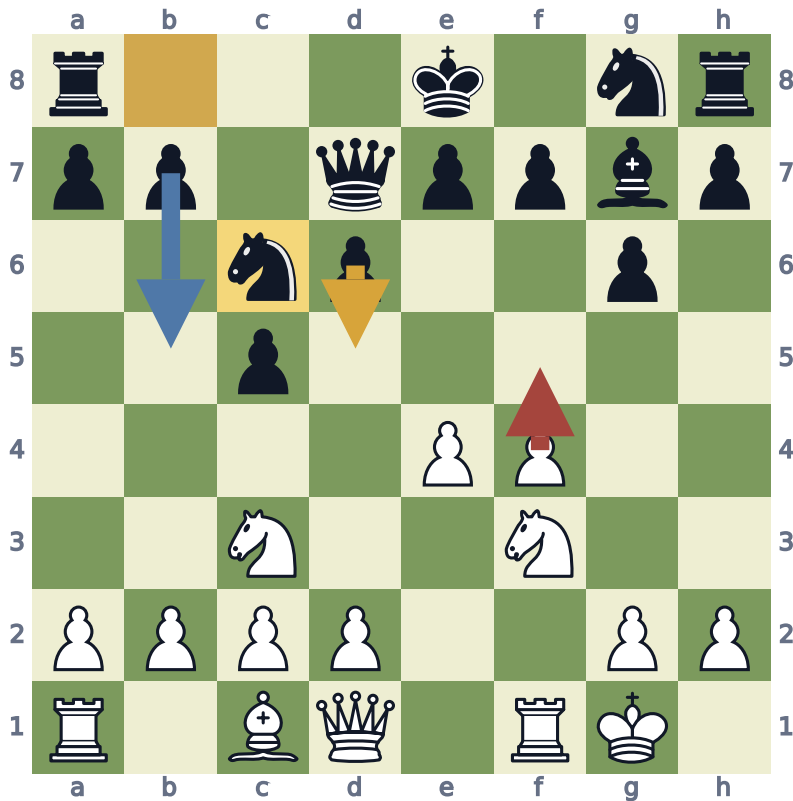
1. White develops an immediate kingside attack with f4 and often Qe1-h4, while Black seeks central and queenside counterplay. 2. Control d4 and e5, exchange the active bishop when useful, and prepare ...e6 or ...Nd4. 3. White uses f5, Qe1-h4, and e5 to open the king before Black organizes the center. 4. Which square stops White's attack most efficiently: e5, d4, or the h4 route? 5. Castling automatically into a fully prepared attack without checking alternative king plans.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 10 plies from memory, then replay: 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bb5+ Bd7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Grand Prix setup with ...g6



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

White develops an immediate kingside attack with f4 and often Qe1-h4, while Black seeks central and queenside counterplay.

DECISION RULE

Which square stops White's attack most efficiently: e5, d4, or the h4 route?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Control d4 and e5, exchange the active bishop when useful, and prepare ...e6 or ...Nd4.

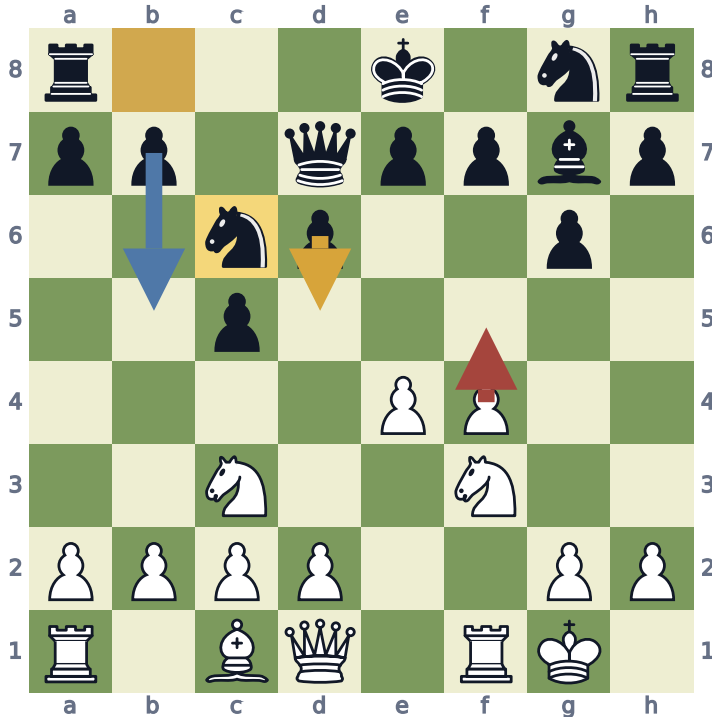
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses f5, Qe1-h4, and e5 to open the king before Black organizes the center.

MEMORY RULE | Against the Grand Prix, control the launch squares before chasing the attacking pieces.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White develops an immediate kingside attack with f4 and often Qe1-h4, while Black seeks central and queenside counterplay.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Control d4 and e5, exchange the active bishop when useful, and prepare ...e6 or ...Nd4.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White uses f5, Qe1-h4, and e5 to open the king before Black organizes the center.

FAILURE MODE

Castling automatically into a fully prepared attack without checking alternative king plans.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which square stops White's attack most efficiently: e5, d4, or the h4 route? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

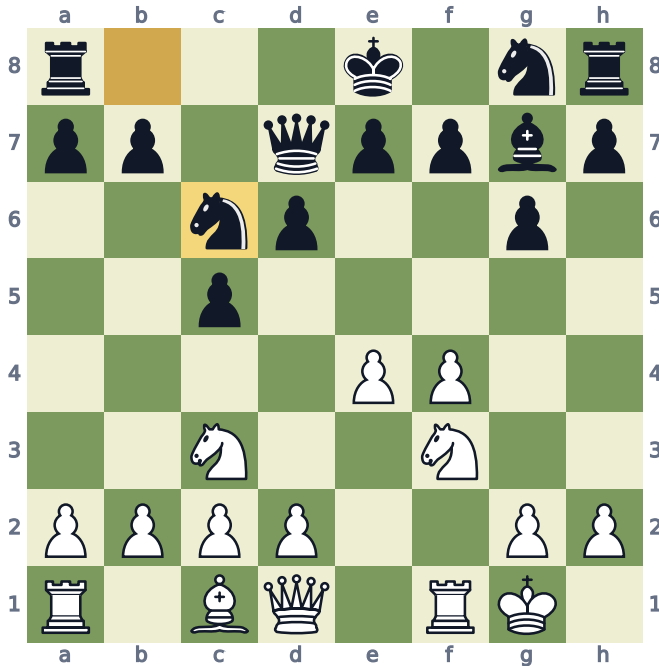
RULE | Against the Grand Prix, control the launch squares before chasing the attacking pieces.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 d6 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bb5+ Bd7 6. Bxd7+ Qxd7 7. O-O Nc6



- Bb5+: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bd7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bxd7+: White releases tension by capturing on d7; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Qxd7: Black releases tension by capturing on d7; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

White develops an immediate kingside attack with f4 and often Qe1-h4, while Black seeks central and queenside counterplay.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which square stops White's attack most efficiently: e5, d4, or the h4 route? White's resistance is: White uses f5, Qe1-h4, and e5 to open the king before Black organizes the center. The line fails as a template when: Castling automatically into a fully prepared attack without checking alternative king plans.

STORE THIS | Against the Grand Prix, control the launch squares before chasing the attacking pieces.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

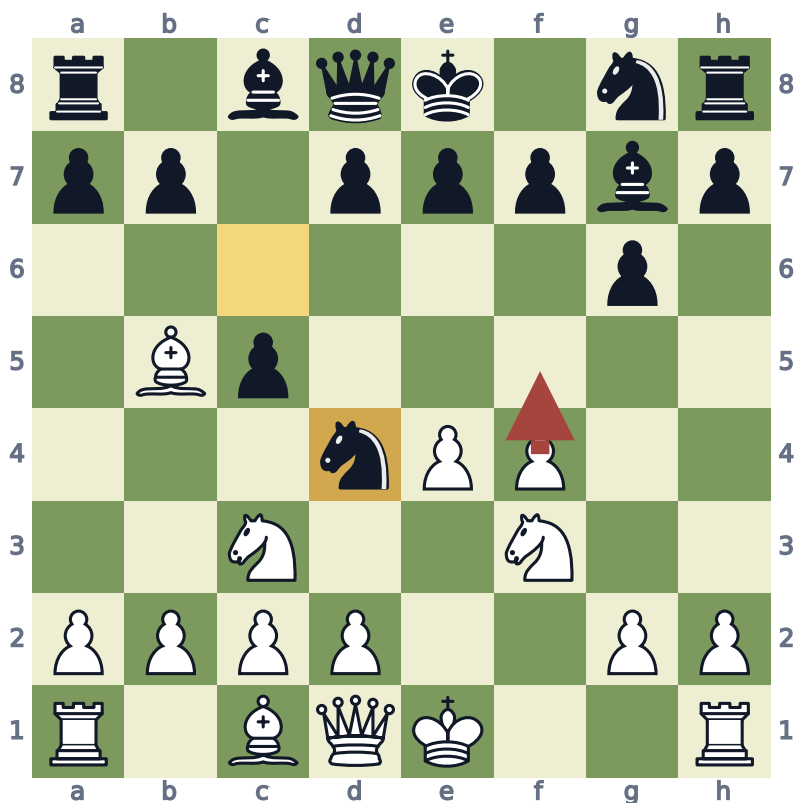
1. White develops an immediate kingside attack with f4 and often Qe1-h4, while Black seeks central and queenside counterplay. 2. Control d4 and e5, exchange the active bishop when useful, and prepare ...e6 or ...Nd4. 3. White uses f5, Qe1-h4, and e5 to open the king before Black organizes the center. 4. Which square stops White's attack most efficiently: e5, d4, or the h4 route? 5. Castling automatically into a fully prepared attack without checking alternative king plans.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. Bb5+ Bd7 6. Bxd7+ Qxd7 7. O-O Nc6

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The Bb5+ exchange decision



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Bb5 often aims to remove a key defender or provoke a blocking piece; Black can sometimes use ...Nd4 to gain central activity instead.

DECISION RULE

After each bishop response, who benefits from the resulting knight placement and pawn structure?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Calculate exchanges on b5 and d4, and welcome trades that reduce attacking force without conceding structure.

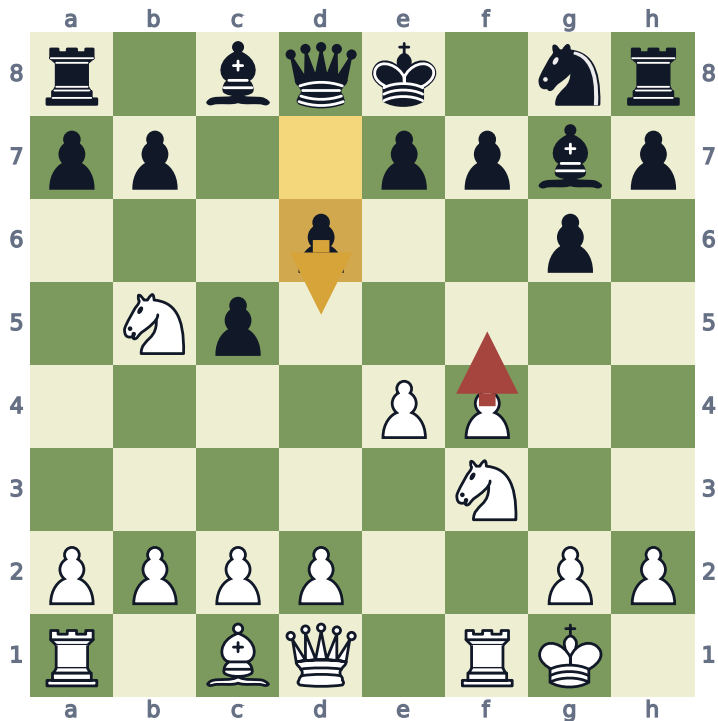
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White preserves attacking pieces or damages Black's queenside before continuing f5.

MEMORY RULE | Trade attackers when the resulting structure remains playable and active.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Bb5 often aims to remove a key defender or provoke a blocking piece; Black can sometimes use ...Nd4 to gain central activity instead.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Calculate exchanges on b5 and d4, and welcome trades that reduce attacking force without conceding structure.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White preserves attacking pieces or damages Black's queenside before continuing f5.

FAILURE MODE

Avoiding every structural imperfection even when an exchange extinguishes White's attack.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After each bishop response, who benefits from the resulting knight placement and pawn structure? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

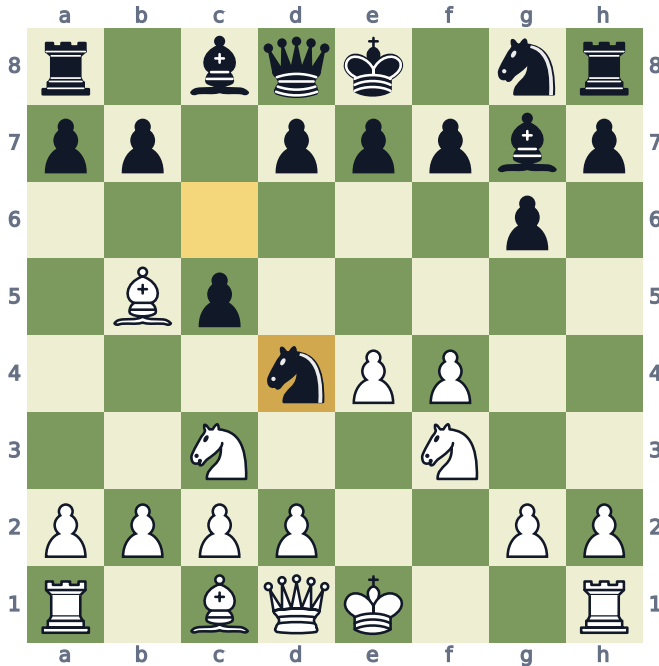
RULE | Trade attackers when the resulting structure remains playable and active.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bb5 Nd4 6. O-O Nxb5 7. Nxb5 d6



- f4: White claims kingside space and announces e5 or f5 attacking ideas.
- g6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Nf3: White reroutes a knight to f3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bg7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bb5: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Nd4: Black reroutes a knight to d4; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Bb5 often aims to remove a key defender or provoke a blocking piece; Black can sometimes use ...Nd4 to gain central activity instead.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After each bishop response, who benefits from the resulting knight placement and pawn structure? White's resistance is: White preserves attacking pieces or damages Black's queenside before continuing f5. The line fails as a template when: Avoiding every structural imperfection even when an exchange extinguishes White's attack.

STORE THIS | Trade attackers when the resulting structure remains playable and active.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

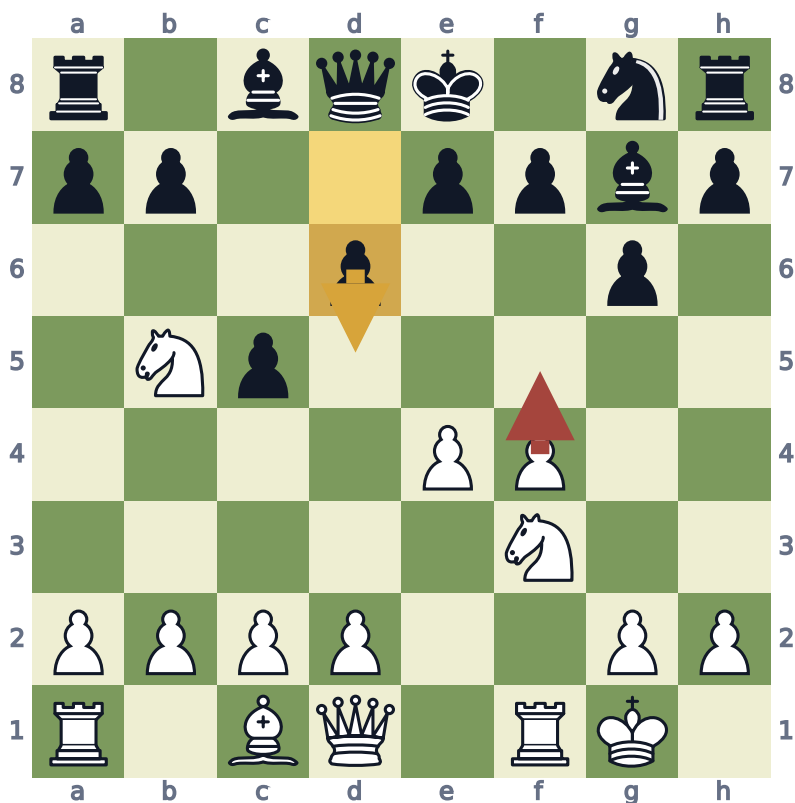
1. Bb5 often aims to remove a key defender or provoke a blocking piece; Black can sometimes use ...Nd4 to gain central activity instead. 2. Calculate exchanges on b5 and d4, and welcome trades that reduce attacking force without conceding structure. 3. White preserves attacking pieces or damages Black's queenside before continuing f5. 4. After each bishop response, who benefits from the resulting knight placement and pawn structure? 5. Avoiding every structural imperfection even when an exchange extinguishes White's attack.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 10 plies from memory, then replay: 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bb5 Nd4

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The Bb5+ exchange decision



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Bb5 often aims to remove a key defender or provoke a blocking piece; Black can sometimes use ...Nd4 to gain central activity instead.

DECISION RULE

After each bishop response, who benefits from the resulting knight placement and pawn structure?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Calculate exchanges on b5 and d4, and welcome trades that reduce attacking force without conceding structure.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White preserves attacking pieces or damages Black's queenside before continuing f5.

MEMORY RULE | Trade attackers when the resulting structure remains playable and active.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Bb5 often aims to remove a key defender or provoke a blocking piece; Black can sometimes use ...Nd4 to gain central activity instead.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Calculate exchanges on b5 and d4, and welcome trades that reduce attacking force without conceding structure.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White preserves attacking pieces or damages Black's queenside before continuing f5.

FAILURE MODE

Avoiding every structural imperfection even when an exchange extinguishes White's attack.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After each bishop response, who benefits from the resulting knight placement and pawn structure? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

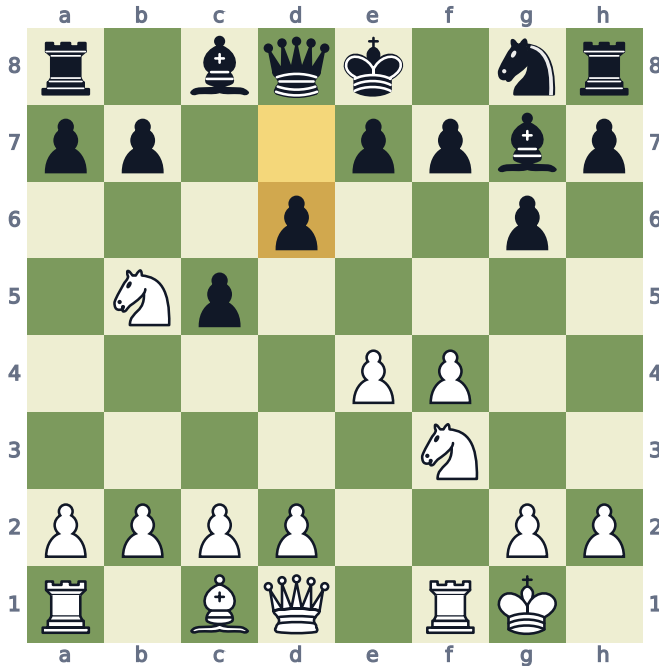
RULE | Trade attackers when the resulting structure remains playable and active.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bb5 Nd4 6. O-O Nxb5 7. Nxb5 d6



- Bb5: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Nd4: Black reroutes a knight to d4; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Nxb5: Black releases tension by capturing on b5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nxb5: White releases tension by capturing on b5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Bb5 often aims to remove a key defender or provoke a blocking piece; Black can sometimes use ...Nd4 to gain central activity instead.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After each bishop response, who benefits from the resulting knight placement and pawn structure? White's resistance is: White preserves attacking pieces or damages Black's queenside before continuing f5. The line fails as a template when: Avoiding every structural imperfection even when an exchange extinguishes White's attack.

STORE THIS | Trade attackers when the resulting structure remains playable and active.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

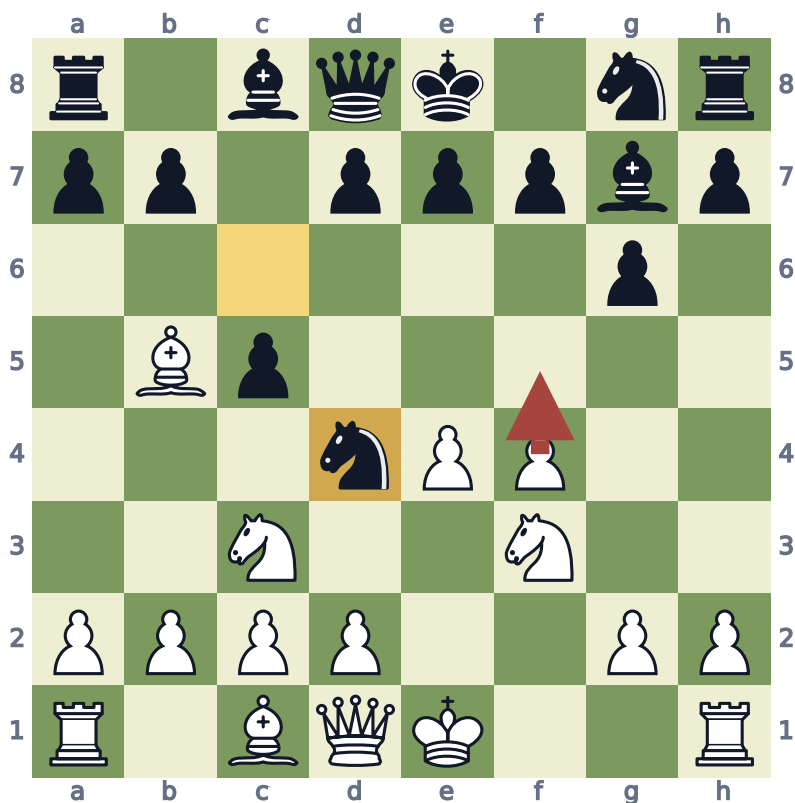
1. Bb5 often aims to remove a key defender or provoke a blocking piece; Black can sometimes use ...Nd4 to gain central activity instead. 2. Calculate exchanges on b5 and d4, and welcome trades that reduce attacking force without conceding structure. 3. White preserves attacking pieces or damages Black's queenside before continuing f5. 4. After each bishop response, who benefits from the resulting knight placement and pawn structure? 5. Avoiding every structural imperfection even when an exchange extinguishes White's attack.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. Bb5 Nd4 6. O-O Nxb5 7. Nxb5 d6

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Central ...d5 against the attack

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

Black's central control can force White to spend time stabilizing e4 and d3 instead of building the kingside attack.

DECISION RULE

Is ...d5 tactically sound now, and if not, which move makes it unavoidable?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use ...e6, ...Ne7, and a prepared ...d5; challenge the center while White's pieces point away from it.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White tries to play f5 or e5 before Black's break equalizes the space.

MEMORY RULE | The center is the shortest route to an attacker whose pieces face the wing.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Black's central control can force White to spend time stabilizing e4 and d3 instead of building the kingside attack.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use ...e6, ...Ne7, and a prepared ...d5; challenge the center while White's pieces point away from it.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White tries to play f5 or e5 before Black's break equalizes the space.

FAILURE MODE

Answering a wing attack only with wing defense and leaving the center untouched.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Is ...d5 tactically sound now, and if not, which move makes it unavoidable? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

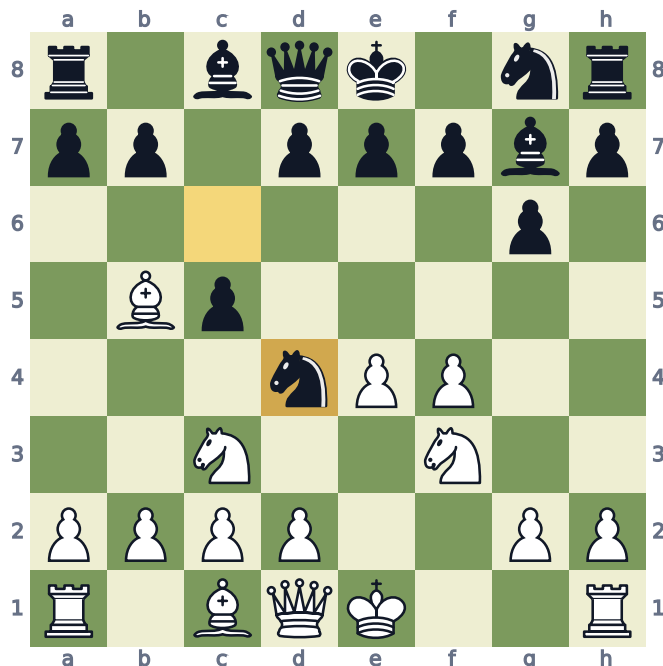
RULE | The center is the shortest route to an attacker whose pieces face the wing.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bb5 Nd4 6. O-O e6 7. d3 Ne7



- f4: White claims kingside space and announces e5 or f5 attacking ideas.
- g6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Nf3: White reroutes a knight to f3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bg7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bb5: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Nd4: Black reroutes a knight to d4; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Black's central control can force White to spend time stabilizing e4 and d3 instead of building the kingside attack.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Is ...d5 tactically sound now, and if not, which move makes it unavoidable? White's resistance is: White tries to play f5 or e5 before Black's break equalizes the space. The line fails as a template when: Answering a wing attack only with wing defense and leaving the center untouched.

STORE THIS | The center is the shortest route to an attacker whose pieces face the wing.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Black's central control can force White to spend time stabilizing e4 and d3 instead of building the kingside attack. 2. Use ...e6, ...Ne7, and a prepared ...d5; challenge the center while White's pieces point away from it. 3. White tries to play f5 or e5 before Black's break equalizes the space. 4. Is ...d5 tactically sound now, and if not, which move makes it unavoidable? 5. Answering a wing attack only with wing defense and leaving the center untouched.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 10 plies from memory, then replay: 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bb5 Nd4

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Central ...d5 against the attack



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Black's central control can force White to spend time stabilizing e4 and d3 instead of building the kingside attack.

DECISION RULE

Is ...d5 tactically sound now, and if not, which move makes it unavoidable?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use ...e6, ...Ne7, and a prepared ...d5; challenge the center while White's pieces point away from it.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White tries to play f5 or e5 before Black's break equalizes the space.

MEMORY RULE | The center is the shortest route to an attacker whose pieces face the wing.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Black's central control can force White to spend time stabilizing e4 and d3 instead of building the kingside attack.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use ...e6, ...Ne7, and a prepared ...d5; challenge the center while White's pieces point away from it.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White tries to play f5 or e5 before Black's break equalizes the space.

FAILURE MODE

Answering a wing attack only with wing defense and leaving the center untouched.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Is ...d5 tactically sound now, and if not, which move makes it unavoidable? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

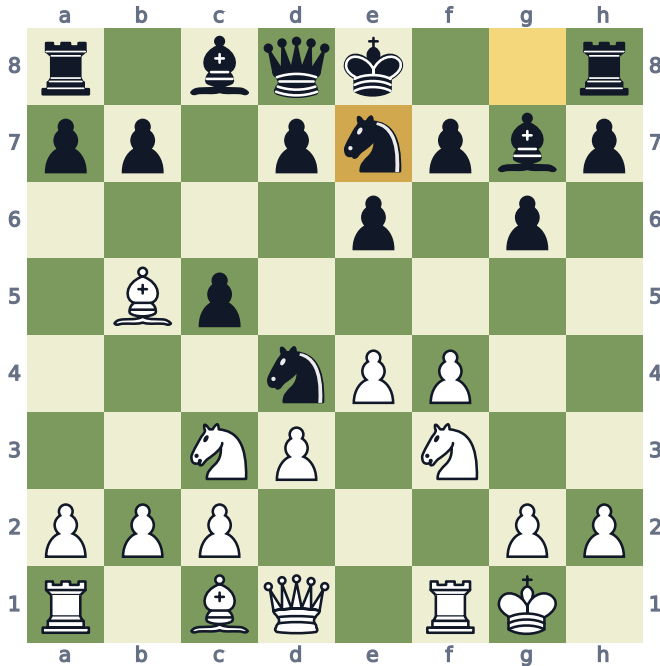
RULE | The center is the shortest route to an attacker whose pieces face the wing.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bb5 Nd4 6. O-O e6 7. d3 Ne7



- Bb5: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Nd4: Black reroutes a knight to d4; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- d3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Ne7: Black reroutes a knight to e7; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Black's central control can force White to spend time stabilizing e4 and d3 instead of building the kingside attack.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Is ...d5 tactically sound now, and if not, which move makes it unavoidable? White's resistance is: White tries to play f5 or e5 before Black's break equalizes the space. The line fails as a template when: Answering a wing attack only with wing defense and leaving the center untouched.

STORE THIS | The center is the shortest route to an attacker whose pieces face the wing.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Black's central control can force White to spend time stabilizing e4 and d3 instead of building the kingside attack. 2. Use ...e6, ...Ne7, and a prepared ...d5; challenge the center while White's pieces point away from it. 3. White tries to play f5 or e5 before Black's break equalizes the space. 4. Is ...d5 tactically sound now, and if not, which move makes it unavoidable? 5. Answering a wing attack only with wing defense and leaving the center untouched.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. Bb5 Nd4 6. O-O e6 7. d3 Ne7

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 073 Decode: Grand Prix setup with ...g6

Prompt: Which square stops White's attack most efficiently: e5, d4, or the h4 route?

Recall: Against the Grand Prix, control the launch squares before chasing the attacking pieces.

LESSON 074 Play: Grand Prix setup with ...g6

Prompt: Which square stops White's attack most efficiently: e5, d4, or the h4 route?

Recall: Against the Grand Prix, control the launch squares before chasing the attacking pieces.

LESSON 075 Decode: The Bb5+ exchange decision

Prompt: After each bishop response, who benefits from the resulting knight placement and pawn structure?

Recall: Trade attackers when the resulting structure remains playable and active.

LESSON 076 Play: The Bb5+ exchange decision

Prompt: After each bishop response, who benefits from the resulting knight placement and pawn structure?

Recall: Trade attackers when the resulting structure remains playable and active.

LESSON 077 Decode: Central ...d5 against the attack

Prompt: Is ...d5 tactically sound now, and if not, which move makes it unavoidable?

Recall: The center is the shortest route to an attacker whose pieces face the wing.

LESSON 078 Play: Central ...d5 against the attack

Prompt: Is ...d5 tactically sound now, and if not, which move makes it unavoidable?

Recall: The center is the shortest route to an attacker whose pieces face the wing.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

Grand Prix setup with ...g6

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 d6 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bb5+ Bd7 6. Bxd7+ Qxd7 7. O-O Nc6

Decision: Which square stops White's attack most efficiently: e5, d4, or the h4 route?

Memory: Against the Grand Prix, control the launch squares before chasing the attacking pieces.

CARD 2

The Bb5+ exchange decision

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bb5 Nd4 6. O-O Nxb5 7. Nxb5 d6

Decision: After each bishop response, who benefits from the resulting knight placement and pawn structure?

Memory: Trade attackers when the resulting structure remains playable and active.

CARD 3

Central ...d5 against the attack

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bb5 Nd4 6. O-O e6 7. d3 Ne7

Decision: Is ...d5 tactically sound now, and if not, which move makes it unavoidable?

Memory: The center is the shortest route to an attacker whose pieces face the wing.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
073 Decode: Grand Prix setup with ...g6	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
074 Play: Grand Prix setup with ...g6	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
075 Decode: The Bb5+ exchange decision	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
076 Play: The Bb5+ exchange decision	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
077 Decode: Central ...d5 against the attack	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
078 Play: Central ...d5 against the attack	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.